



Tandy Corporation/Radio Shack

News Release

For Release:

August 3, 1987

RS-88-007

For Further
Information

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NEW TANDY PROFESSIONAL DESKMATE INTEGRATED SOFTWARE PACKAGE FEATURES WORKGROUP SUPPORT

NEW YORK CITY--Radio Shack®, a division of Tandy Corporation, introduced today an innovation in software engineering with the Professional DeskMate™ program, a new state-of-the-art version of Tandy's popular integrated business package.

Tandy's in-house designed Professional DeskMate software rivals the industry's most advanced user interfaces. It uses Microsoft® Windows conventions including mouse-controlled pull-down menus and pop-up dialogue boxes. The Tandy program, however, offers the added dimension of color on EGA-equipped systems. For users who prefer, cursor movement may also be controlled by simplified keyboard commands.

It may be used on a stand-alone machine or in a workgroup environment in which users exchange messages and data and share devices. Connectivity can be achieved through a simple RS-232 interconnection, sophisticated network systems such as those sold by 3Com Corporation, or by TandyLink™, Radio Shack's newest twisted-pair network.

--More--

Professional DeskMate Software--ADD ONE

Applications include word processing, spreadsheet analysis, electronic mail and an electronic filing program that enables the user to create databases and design reports.

A new feature is DRAW, a graphics editor that allows the user to create simple business graphics, such as organizational charts, using ready-made templates.

The most significant enhancement in Professional DeskMate is in the area of connectivity through a facility called "DeskLink". This facility allows users to transfer files between machines or perform a variety of useful workgroup functions. The transfer of files between computers is as simple as pointing to the file through the DeskLink accessory and executing the COPY command. DeskLink's print option allows users in a workgroup environment to print to a remote printer.

DeskLink allows workgroup members to share several applications. For example, MAIL provides users with an electronic message center through which messages, along with attachments such as word processing files, can be sent, stored and recalled. Another shared resource is PHONE. A phone directory may include a personal list as well as a shared central phone list.

An event-oriented CALENDAR provides workgroup functionality with the ability to manage a shared calendar, including automatic scheduling of meetings among several people. Schedules of individual group members can also be displayed.

--More--

Professional DeskMate Software--ADD TWO

A graphic representation of time appears on each day of the calendar providing immediate information on how any particular day is scheduled. Events can be viewed by day with graphic representation of scheduled time periods. Weekly, monthly or yearly recurring events can also be included on the calendar.

Designed for Tandy's complete line of PC-compatible personal computers, Professional DeskMate (25-1178) has a suggested retail price of \$149.95. It supports a wide range of video displays, such as EGA, in addition to the Tandy® 1000 computer graphics modes.

Additionally, Professional DeskMate is readily available in the background. With a simple keystroke other application software may be "put to sleep" and easily returned.

Installing DeskLink is as simple as typing DESKLINK and answering a few questions. All DeskLink functions are written to IBM's NetBIOS standard making it compatible in a variety of hardware environments, including the new TandyLink network adapter board.

This low-cost (well under \$150 per node) network board is electrically compatible with Apple Computer's AppleTalk® network and includes the network connectors. It operates at a bit rate of 768 kilobaud (Kbaud), more than three times faster than the AppleTalk standard of 230.4 Kbaud. Using software, such as Centram's TOPS® for PC, the TandyLink board can communicate with Apple Macintosh™ computers as well as PC-compatibles operating at the standard AppleTalk rate.

--More--

Professional DeskMate Software--ADD THREE

Both the Professional DeskMate software and the TandyLink network adapter will be available in the fourth quarter of 1987, exclusively through Radio Shack.

Suggested retail prices are good at Radio Shack stores, Radio Shack Computer Centers®, Radio Shack Plus Computer Centers™, and participating dealers nationwide.

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